

How Security Savvy Are You (Online)?

Check your knowledge of the following terms used in online security:

Adware: Software that displays advertising on a computer. Sometimes it runs with the user's knowledge, and sometimes it runs without the user's knowledge. May monitor browsing activities and relay that information to a marketer.

Back-ups: An extra copy of computer files, usually kept in a separate physical space from the original. Very important for recovery when original files are lost or damaged.

Bot or web bot: Short for robot, this is an automated program, such as a Web crawler, that simulates human actions on the Internet. Although often used for legitimate purposes (such as by search engines), a web bot can be used to take control of computers, launch attacks, or compromise data.

Cloning: Copying or replicating (usually a website) for the purpose of obtaining money or data from unsuspecting users.

Cloud: A way to store and access data over the Internet instead of a computer's hard drive. A cloud is actually space on the Internet.

Cookie: A small text file that is placed on a computer when the user visits a website. It is used to remember the user's preferences or track browsing activities. These are not programs and cannot read hard drives or cause damage to the computer.

Data breaches: Unauthorized access to confidential information

Data disposal: Dumping of data

Email encryption and Internet activity: A security measure that turns information into indecipherable code; often used to make online purchasing secure.

Firewalls: Hardware or software devices that control network access and communications between a network and the Internet, or between one part of a network and another. Personal firewalls are also used to block hackers and unauthorized traffic, while allowing access to authorized traffic.

Http/https: Hypertext transfer protocol/hypertext transfer protocol, secure. Websites with an S use encryption and/or authentication measures.

Hacker: A person who uses programming skills or technical knowledge to gain unauthorized access to computer systems for malicious or criminal purposes.

Keylogger: Software that captures a user's keystrokes; may be used to gather passwords, user names, or other private information.

Lock wireless network: Security measures to protect wireless networks from hackers. Measures may include changing passwords, changing the Service Set ID (SSID), enabling encryption, enabling media access control filtering, limiting the number of IP addresses a router can assign to devices, or blocking wan requests.

Malware scans: Software designed to do harm by causing damage to systems or data, invading privacy, stealing information or gaining unauthorized access. Includes viruses, worms, Trojan horses, spyware, adware, and bots.

Password vaults, storage tools: Password vaults store encrypted passwords, requiring the user to create a master password which grants the user access to the password database.

Password: A first line of protection that prohibits access to a computer, system or network unless the user enters the correct sequence of keys.

Phishing: An attempt to mislead people into divulging confidential information (e.g., passwords, Social Security numbers). Phishing uses legitimate-looking email or instant messaging in combination with fake websites to make fraudulent requests for information.

Software updates: Software manufacturers offer software updates to plug discovered security holes. Microsoft is known for its "patch Tuesdays," during which patches are sent to users for known issues, such as bugs or security holes.

Spyware: Software that runs in the background and collects information about a computer and how it is used and sends that information to others over the Internet. It sometimes installs itself on a computer without the user's knowledge or consent.

Suspicious links and personal info: It's best not to click on links from people you don't know or on unsolicited links from others. You should also never provide personal information without verifying the source requesting that information.

Trojan horse: A malicious program that looks like legitimate software that often allows someone else to take over a computer. It may attack data or systems. Unlike viruses and worms, Trojan horses cannot replicate themselves.

Virus: A program that can self-replicate and infect files, programs, and operating systems.

Worms: A malicious program that can copy and reproduce itself over the Internet using email programs or other transport tools. May cause system and data damage.